

Title

Protocol for an 8-week evaluation of Baduanjin practice combined with computerized cognitive remediation in hospitalized schizophrenia: methods and theoretical framework

Abstract

Schizophrenia remains a major source of disability globally, with limited pharmacological impact on cognitive deficits and functional outcomes beyond symptom suppression. Integration of mind-body practices with cognitive rehabilitation may address these gaps. This protocol describes a randomized trial comparing combined Baduanjin (traditional Chinese mind-body exercise) and computer-assisted cognitive remediation versus cognitive remediation alone. Participants will be 120 hospitalized patients aged 29-64 with schizophrenia. The combined-intervention arm will receive 85-minute sessions (40 minutes Baduanjin, 45 minutes computerized cognitive tasks) five days per week for 8 weeks. Control participants receive identical computerized cognitive work without movement training. Measurements occur at baseline and week 8, assessing psychiatric symptoms (PANSS), neurocognitive performance (NCSE), social functioning (SSPI), and subjective quality of life (SQLS). Intent-to-treat analysis will evaluate intervention efficacy on symptom severity and functional domains.